Lesson plan · for the teacher

Confident, wrong and risky

AI security · Level 1 · Lesson 2

Time
40 min

Materials
A ladder with three rungs drawn on the board: low, medium, high; Five made-up AI answers on paper strips, from a poem to advice about medicine or chemicals; The textbook, to check one answer together

Learning goals

- Explain why a confident AI answer can be wrong.
- Place AI answers on a stakes ladder.
- Choose the right check, and who to ask.

Activity: The stakes ladder

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask pupils about a time someone told them something confidently that turned out wrong. Agree that sounding sure isn't proof.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain that AI chatbots predict likely words, so they can be wrong and sound sure. Draw the ladder: low (read it), medium (the textbook), high (an expert, and a person decides).
3. Ladder (15 min): Read out five made-up AI answers: a poem about rain, a fractions quiz, a school-trip date, how to treat a burn, which cleaning products are safe to mix. Groups put each on a rung and write how they would check it.
4. Check it (7 min): Take the fractions quiz and check two of its answers in the textbook together. Point out one confident mistake if there is one.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): List the experts for high-stakes answers: the school nurse, the head teacher, the exam board. Then give the exit ticket.

Write the five answers on paper strips beforehand. Make the burn and cleaning answers clearly dangerous (for example “mix bleach and vinegar”), so pupils learn never to try them, and say so.

Discussion

- Why can an AI answer sound sure and still be wrong?
- Which answer was the hardest to place on the ladder?
- Who can you ask when an answer is about health or safety?

Exit ticket

- Write one AI answer that would be high stakes, and who you would ask to check it.

Try it in class tomorrow
Build a stakes ladder with your class: read out five AI answers, from a poem to advice about medicine. Groups place each one on a low, medium or high rung and say how they would check it.

Worksheet · for pupils

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **An AI drafted a letter to parents about the new exam rules. What do you do before it goes out?**

◯ Check every rule against the official notice ◯ Ask the AI if it's sure ◯ Send it: it reads well

2 **If two different chatbots give the same answer, you don't need to check it.**

◯ True ◯ False

3 **Which are high stakes, needing an expert or an official source? Choose all that apply.**

☐ Ideas for a classroom display ☐ Advice about a pupil's medicine

☐ The date of the national exam ☐ Which chemicals are safe to mix in the lab

☐ A title for a class story

4 **Put the checks in order, from the lightest to the strongest.**

☐ Check it against the textbook

☐ Read it yourself

☐ Let a person decide

☐ Ask an expert or the official source

5 **Complete the rule.**

The higher the _____ , the stronger the _____ .

Word bank: speed · stakes · price · check

Answers · for the teacher

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1 **Check every rule against the official notice**

Exam rules are high stakes: one wrong rule misleads every family.

2 **False**

Chatbots learn from much of the same text and can repeat the same mistake.

3 **Advice about a pupil's medicine; Which chemicals are safe to mix in the lab; The date of the national exam**

Health, safety and official dates can hurt people or mislead families if they are wrong, so they need an expert or the official source.

4 **Top to bottom: 2, 1, 4, 3**

The ladder climbs with the stakes: your own reading, then a trusted book, then the expert or official source, and for the highest stakes a person makes the decision, not the AI.

5 **The higher the stakes, the stronger the check.**

Match the effort to the harm a mistake could do: light checks for low stakes, an expert and a person deciding for high stakes.

For you to think about

Think of AI answers you or your pupils used this month. Which were high stakes, and were they checked?